

Two-Point Perspective

The most commonly used perspective system

Two-point perspective uses two vanishing points on the horizon line and is the workhorse of architectural and product drawing. It handles any object viewed from a corner — which is most of real life.

KEY CONCEPTS

The Setup

Draw a horizon line. Place two VPs — one far left, one far right (well outside your drawing area if possible). All lines receding left go to the left VP; all lines receding right go to the right VP. Vertical lines remain perfectly vertical.

Drawing a Box in 2PP

1) Draw a vertical line (the nearest edge). 2) From the top of this line, draw lines to both VPs. 3) From the bottom, draw lines to both VPs. 4) Add two more vertical lines to define the side faces. 5) Close the top.

VP Distance Matters

Vanishing points too close together create extreme distortion — the box looks like it's seen through a wide-angle lens. Place VPs as far apart as possible (off-canvas) for natural-looking perspective.

When to Use 2PP

Any time you're drawing architecture, furniture, vehicles, or objects viewed from a corner angle. Most exterior building drawings use 2PP. Combine 1PP and 2PP in the same scene for varied geometry.

PRACTICE EXERCISES

1. Draw 10 boxes in 2PP — vary the box sizes and positions relative to the horizon.
2. Draw a simple building exterior in 2PP (front face + one side face visible).
3. Draw an entire city block in 2PP from a corner viewpoint.

FURTHER READING

■ Proko – 2 Point Perspective

<https://youtu.be/nAlCyQqEZSU>

■ Draw a Box – Rotated Boxes

<https://drawabox.com/lesson/1/8>